ACTIVITY 7

Right and wrong application of plastics

Look at the list of eight plastic items. Decide which fourplastic itemsare used for the right application and which four are used for the wrong application by filling in the chart below:

Plastic items: straws, helmets, cutlery, thin carry bags, syringes, electrical wires,tea cups and blood bags



Straws



Helmets



Cutlery



Thin carry bags



Syringes



Electrical wires



Tea cups



Blood bags

Right application	Wrong application

3.4.2 Types of plastics

The plastics we use in our daily life are also made up of polymers. All plastics do not have the same type of arrangement of units. In some articles, the arrangement of a monomer is linear, and in some other items, the arrangement of articles is cross-linked. Depending on the type of arrangement, we have two main types of polymers – thermoplastics and thermoset. Let us see what these are!

Thermoplastics : Polyethylene (also called polythene) is an example of a plastic. It is used for making polythene carry bags which are commonly used. When you burn a polythene carry bag, it melts and turns into liquid along with the production of an offensive odour, a bright flame and soot. Another example is a **PET (Polyethylene Terephthalate)** bottle, when we fill it with boiling water, it gets deformed. Plastics which can be easily softened and bent when heated are known as thermoplastics. These plastics can be modified and turned into another plastic item through the process of recycling.

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